

Suspicious Activity Report (SAR) Filing SOP

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1. Scope

This SOP describes how NWB prepares, reviews, approves and files SARs. It applies to every case an L2 investigator decides is suspicious under NWB-POL-101.

2. Deadlines

The regulatory deadline is 30 calendar days from the initial detection date. NWB defines the initial detection date as the day the alert was escalated to L2 (Day 0). If no suspect can be identified, the regulatory deadline may be extended by up to 30 additional days with BSA/AML Officer approval. NWB's internal targets are stricter than the regulatory deadline:

Day (from L2 escalation)	Milestone	Owner
Day 0	Alert escalated to L2; case opened in case manager	L2 investigator
Day 10	Investigation complete; case / no-case decision recorded	L2 investigator
Day 15	Draft SAR narrative submitted to QA	L2 investigator (preparer)
Day 20	QA review complete	FIU QA Lead
Day 25	Approval and electronic filing (internal target)	BSA/AML Officer
Day 30	Regulatory filing deadline - must not be missed	BSA/AML Officer

3. Approvers

Role	Name	Authority
Preparer	Assigned L2 investigator	Drafts narrative and supporting schedule
Reviewer	FIU QA Lead - Grace Adeyemi	Validates narrative quality, 5 W's, completeness
Approver	BSA/AML Officer - Dana Whitfield	Final approval and filing
Delegate approver	Deputy BSA Officer - Marcus Oyelaran	Approves when BSA/AML Officer is unavailable

4. High-Risk Customer Handling

When a SAR is filed on a customer rated High risk, Enhanced Due Diligence (EDD) must be refreshed within 15 calendar days of filing, and the relationship is referred to the Customer Exit Committee if two SARs are filed within 12 months.

5. Continuing Activity

Activity on a customer with a filed SAR is reviewed every 90 days. A continuing-activity SAR, if warranted, must be filed within 120 days of the previous SAR filing date.

6. Confidentiality

SAR existence must never be disclosed to the subject. Case notes must not reference SAR filing in customer-facing systems.